

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q T 4 2

♥ 9 8 5

♦ T 9 7

♣ A 4

♠ 6 3

♥ A J 3

♦ K 5 2

♣ K Q J 6 2



♠ 9 8 7

♥ T 7 6 4 2

♦ A 6 4 3

♣ 7

♠ A J 5

♥ K Q

♦ Q J 8

♣ T 9 8 5 3

[show NW]

[showcards W:SK E:S7 S:S5]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♠K, East played the ♠7 and South the ♠5.

What do you play to the second trick?

When you have made your choice click NEXT.

[choose-card D10] [NEXT]

[show NESW]

[clear-commentary]

Play the ♦10, NOT another ♠.

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

3 ♣

Pass

1 ♣

All Pass

3NT by South

You can see the ♠6, ♠5, ♠4, ♠3 and ♠2. So the ♠7 is East's lowest ♠, he is doing his best to discourage you from leading the suit again.

South held up with ♠ A J x, hoping you would play the suit again and give him two tricks.

If you play the ♦10 East will win the ♦A and return a ♠, allowing you to drive out South's ♠A while you still have the ♣A for an entry.

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q T 4 2

♥ 9 8 5

♦ T 9 7

♣ A 4

♠ 6 3

♥ A J 3

♦ K 5 2

♣ K Q J 6 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 7 5

♥ T 7 6 4 2

♦ A 6 4 3

♣ 7

♠ A 9 8

♥ K Q

♦ Q J 8

♣ T 9 8 5 3

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

3 ♣

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

You cannot see the ♠5. The most likely reason is that East has it, and his ♠7 is an encouraging signal. The only reason he would encourage you is if he held either the ♠A or ♠J.

Together, you two continue to play ♠s to drive out South's ♠A. When you get the lead with your ♣A you will cash your ♠ winners and East will still have the ♦A for some icing on the cake.

There IS another possibility if South is a better than average Declarer. East just might hold ♠9 7, giving South ♠A J 8 5. South played the ♠8 as a falsecard to tempt you into playing the suit again. This isn't too likely, but if it happens just congratulate South for the fine play.

[show NW]

[showcards W:SK E:S7 S:S8]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♠K, East played the ♠7 and South the ♠8.

What do you play to the second trick?

When you have made your choice click NEXT.

[choose-card S4] [NEXT]

[show NESW]

[clear-commentary]

Play the ♠4.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 5 4
 ♥ 6 4
 ♦ J 7 3
 ♣ A K Q 6 5 3

♠ A T 7 2

♥ K J 8 3

♦ Q 8 6

♣ J 4



♠ K 8 6 3
 ♥ Q T
 ♦ T 9 5 4 2
 ♣ 8 2

♠ Q J 9

♥ A 9 7 5 2

♦ A K

♣ T 9 7

[show NE]

[showcards W:CA]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♣A, dummy played the ♣4 and it is your play.

When you have made your choice click NEXT.

[choose-card C8] [NEXT]

[show NESW]

West

North

East

South

2 ♣

3 ♣

Pass

1 ♥

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by South

West now knows you started with a doubleton, and more importantly, he also knows you want him to play a third ♣.

[clear-commentary]

Play the ♣8 to encourage a continuation. West will play the ♣Q on which you will play the ♣2.

When he next plays the ♣K dummy will ruff, but whatever card he ruffs with you will have established a trump trick. When you later win your ♠K that will be down 1.

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 3
♥ J 8 4 3
♦ K J 9 5 2
♣ 8 2

♠ J 8 4

♥ 7 6 2

♦ 8 4

♣ K J 9 6 5



♠ Q T 9 6 2

♥ T 9

♦ Q 7 3

♣ A 7 4

♠ A K 5

♥ A K Q 5

♦ A T 6

♣ Q T 3

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by South

does then he will need help from you to decide which trick he should win. You play the ♣8 first, and the ♣2 next to show an even number.

If East is paying attention he will know to win the THIRD ♣. This will kill dummy's ♣ suit, and with it South's chance of making 9 tricks.

[show NW]

[showcards W:D5 E:DQ,D7,D3 S:D6,DT,DA,CQ]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♦5, East wins the ♦Q and returns the ♦7. South holds up his ♦A until the third round. He then plays the ♣Q and it is your play.

When you have made your choice click NEXT.

[choose-card C8] [NEXT]

[show NESW]

[clear-commentary]

Play the ♣8.

You assume (hope) that East holds the ♣A. If he does then he will need help from you to decide which trick he should win. You play the ♣8 first, and the ♣2 next to show an even number.

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 7 6 5 2

♥ 3

♦ T 6 4

♣ A K T 5

♠ A

♥ K T 8 2

♦ A Q 7 3

♣ J 8 6 2



♠ Q T 8 4

♥ Q J 9

♦ K 9 5 2

♣ 9 3

♠ K 9 3

♥ A 7 6 5 4

♦ J 8

♣ Q 7 4

West

North

East

South

1 ♦

Pass

1 ♥

Pass

2 ♥

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by South

the ♣K and another which you will have to ruff. You will give up your NATURAL trump trick by doing so. Worse, you will allow North's ♣J to be established as a winner that South can later discard a ♦ on.

Much better to play low. Partner will surely switch to a ♦, and South will probably finesse, though it doesn't matter whether he does or not. You will win the ♦K, return the ♣9 back to West's ♣K, and still have your trump trick for later.

[show NE]

[showcards W:CA]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♣A, dummy played the ♣2 and it is your play.

When you have made your choice click NEXT.

[choose-card C3] [NEXT]

[show NESW]

[clear-commentary]

Play the ♣3.

If you signal with the ♣9 West will continue with the ♣K and another which you will have to ruff. You will give up your NATURAL trump trick by doing so. Worse, you will allow North's ♣J to be established as a winner that South can later discard a ♦ on.

Board 6

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A K Q T 7

♥ T 9

♦ 9 7 2

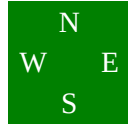
♣ K 8 4

♠ J 6 4 2

♥ J 6 3

♦ A J 6

♣ T 7 3



♠ 9 3

♥ 5 4

♦ Q T 8 3

♣ J 9 6 5 2

♠ 8 5

♥ A K Q 8 7 2

♦ K 5 4

♣ A Q

[show NW]

[showcards W:SA E:S9,S3 S:S5,S8]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♠A, East plays the ♠9, South the ♠5. You assume East has signaled you to continue ♠s, so you play the ♠Q. On this trick East plays the ♠3 and South the ♠8. How will you continue?

When you have made your choice click NEXT.

[choose-card S7] [NEXT]

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

2 ♥

Pass

1 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by South

♠s. You might just switch suits, but you have a better choice.

[show NESW]

[clear-commentary]

You know that both East and South are now void of

If you play your ♠Q, East won't bother ruffing, South **WILL** ruff and dummy's ♠J will be established as a winner.

The best procedure is to lead a low ♠. East will ruff and South will over-ruff but by playing this way you stop the establishment of North's ♠J. As you can see, South would have been able to discard a loser on that ♠J if you hadn't played this way.

Board 7

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 9 6 3

♥ Q J T 7

♦ 8 5 2

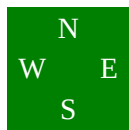
♣ 8 3

♠ J 8

♥ 9 6 2

♦ K Q T 9 4

♣ 9 7 5



♠ A T 5 2

♥ 8 5 3

♦ A 7 3

♣ J 6 2

♠ Q 7 4

♥ A K 4

♦ J 6

♣ A K Q T 4

West

North

East

South

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Play the ♦ 3 and when South plays another ♦ win with your ♦ A.

North hoped his ♦ suit would provide enough tricks to make the game. You can see that there is no entry to the North hand EXCEPT in ♦s, so you want to win your ♦ A on the trick that South plays his last ♦. How can you tell which trick that is?

Only by watching what West plays. On the ♦ J West played the ♦ 2, a low card signaling that he held an ODD number of ♦s. ODD must be either one or three so when he followed to the next ♦ you know he started with three. A little bit of counting tells you that South started with the doubleton Jack, so you want to win the second ♦ trick.

This defense holds South to one ♦ tricks, if you had let him win the second one he would have had 9 tricks.

[show NE]

[showcards S:HA,DJ W:HQ,D2]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥ Q, you played low and South won the ♥ A.

South now plays the ♦ J on which West plays the ♦ 2. What do you play now, and what is your plan.

When you have made your choice click NEXT.

[choose-card D3] [NEXT]

[show NESW]

[clear-commentary]

Board 8

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 6 5
♥ Q T 6 4
♦ K 7 2
♣ T 5 2

♠ K Q 9 3

♥ 8 7 3

♦ Q 6

♣ 9 7 6 4



♠ 8 7 2

♥ J 9 5 2

♦ A 8 4 3

♣ 8 3

♠ J T 4

♥ A K

♦ J T 9 5

♣ A K Q J

West	North	East	South
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Pass

1 ♠

Pass

1 ♣

Pass

3NT

2NT

All Pass

3NT by South
Play the ♠6.

[show NW]

[showcards W:H4 E:S2,HJ S:SJ,ST,HA]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♥4, East plays the ♥J, won by South with ♥A.

South plays the ♠J, you follow with ♠5, dummy ♠3 and East plays the ♠2. South continues with the ♠T and it is your play.

When you have made your choice click NEXT.

[choose-card S6] [NEXT]

[show NESW]

[clear-commentary]

East's ♠2 tells you he had an ODD number of ♠s, obviously 3. Since South also must have 3, you must take your ♠A on the third round, depriving dummy of the extra ♠ trick.

South may now turn to the ♦ suit, but your side can win the first ♦ and drive out South's ♥K. You will win 2 ♥s, 2 ♦s and the ♠A, down 1

Board 9

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 4
♥ A 8 7 5 2
♦ 7 5 2
♣ 6 4 2

♠ K J 6

♥ J T 6 3

♦ A Q 6

♣ Q T 5



♠ 9 7 3 2

♥ -

♦ T 9 8 4 3

♣ A K J 9

♠ A Q T 5

♥ K Q 9 4

♦ K J

♣ 8 7 3

[show NE]

[showcards W:H5]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥5, dummy played the ♥10 and it is your play.

When you have made your choice click NEXT.

[choose-card any:D3,S2] [NEXT]

[show NESW]

[clear-commentary]

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

Play the ♦3 (or the ♠2).

3NT by South

lead. If you discard the ♣9 West will surely get the message and will lead a ♣. BUT - you will only win 3 ♣ tricks. The ♣9 would have been the fourth winner.

You really want West to lead a ♣ if he gets into the

So instead, play a low card in one of the other suits, say the ♦3.

South is one trick short and he sees he can easily get that trick in ♥s. So he plays a second ♥ from dummy and you now discard the ♠2. West takes the ♥A and he can see that you don't want him to lead a ♠ or a ♦. He deduces that you might like a ♣ so he plays his ♣2 and you win 4 tricks.

Board 10

East Deals

None Vul

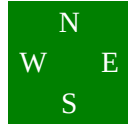
♠ 6 5 3
♥ 4
♦ J 8 6 4 2
♣ J 9 4 3

♠ K J 7

♥ Q J 2

♦ Q T 3

♣ K T 7 5



♠ 8

♥ A T 9 7 6 3

♦ 9 7 5

♣ A 6 2

♠ A Q T 9 4 2

♥ K 8 5

♦ A K

♣ Q 8

West

North

East

South

Pass

3♠

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by South

That means his re-entry, if he has one, is in the lower-ranking suit.

Partner takes the ♣A and gives you a second ♥ ruff.

[show NW]

[showcards W:H4 E:HA,H3 S:H8,H5]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♥4, East takes the ♥A and returns the ♥3. You ruff and then play what???

When you have made your choice click NEXT.

[choose-card any:C4,C3] [NEXT]

[show NESW]

[clear-commentary]

Play a low ♣.

Partner played the ♥3, a low card, for you to ruff.

Board 11

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 8 6 3

♥ T 6

♦ A K 8 4

♣ 8 7 2

♠ K Q 7 5 2

♥ Q 4

♦ 9 6 3

♣ K 9 6



♠ T 9 4

♥ 9 5 3

♦ Q 7 2

♣ A Q J 4

♠ A

♥ A K J 8 7 2

♦ J T 5

♣ T 5 3

[show NE]

[showcards W:DA]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♦ A, dummy played the ♦ 3 and it is your play.

When you have made your choice click NEXT.

[choose-card D2] [NEXT]

[show NESW]

[clear-commentary]

West

North

East

South

Pass

1 ♠

Pass

1 ♥

2 ♥

All Pass

Play the ♦ 2.

2 ♥ by South

you would give an encouraging signal when you hold the Queen. But with this hand you want partner to switch to ♣s as soon as possible. So you play a low ♦.

You know partner also has the ♦ K, and normally

West looks at your signal, then looks at dummy, then looks at your signal. He knows you want a switch and it looks like a switch to ♣s might work the best. South plays a low ♣ from dummy, you win the ♣J. Next you play a low ♦, taken by West with his ♦K. West leads a ♣. Dummy plays the ♣K, you win that, cash another ♣, then cash your ♦Q. That first signal led to your side winning the first 6 tricks. Wow.

Board 12

South Deals

None Vul

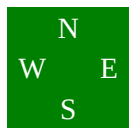
♠ 9 6 4
♥ A K 7 2
♦ A 8 6 3
♣ 9 5

♠ A T 3

♥ T 6

♦ 9 7 2

♣ K Q J 3 2



♠ 8

♥ Q J 8 4 3

♦ Q J T 4

♣ 8 7 6

♠ K Q J 7 5 2

♥ 9 5

♦ K 5

♣ A T 4

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			

4 ♠ by South

the ♥J. In either case you can reach the East hand on the second trick by playing a low ♥. Since you don't particularly want to start playing ♦s from your side, you go ahead and play a small ♥, won by East with the ♥J.

East next plays the ♦Q and however South tries it your side will take the next two ♦ tricks and set the contract.

[show NW]

[showcards W:HA E:HQ S:H5]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♥A, East puts on the ♥Q. It's your play.

When you have made your choice click NEXT.

[choose-card H2] [NEXT]

[show NESW]

[clear-commentary]

Play the ♥2.

East's ♥Q is either a singleton, (practically impossible), or a signal showing that he also holds

Board 13

South Deals

None Vul

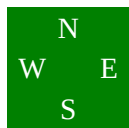
♠ K 8 7 4
 ♥ 6 3
 ♦ A K 9 6
 ♣ 9 5 3

♠ J 5

♥ A Q 9 8 7 5

♦ 5 2

♣ Q T 4



♠ T 9 6 3 2
 ♥ K 2
 ♦ Q J 8
 ♣ 8 7 6

♠ A Q

♥ J T 4

♦ T 7 4 3

♣ A K J 2

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♦

Pass

2♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

Ace and you have a certain trump trick. However, that's all you can see.

Your best hope is that West may be able to win a ♠ trick, and it may be important for the first ♠ lead to come from your side of the table.

Your ♦ Q play informs partner that you also have the ♦ J, giving him the option of underleading his ♦ K to get to your hand.

West next plays a small ♦ which you win with your ♦ J. You return the ♠ T. This establishes West's ♠ K before South can pull trumps and discard one of dummy's ♠ s on his fourth ♣.

[show NE]

[showcards W:DA]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown. West led the ♦ A, dummy played the ♦ 2 and it is your play.

When you have made your choice click NEXT.

[choose-card DQ] [NEXT]

[show NESW]

[clear-commentary]

Play the ♦ Q.

As soon as dummy appears you can see 3 tricks for your side. Partner surely has the ♦ K to go with his

Board 14

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 9 6 5 2
♥ A Q T 6
♦ 9 5 4 2
♣ -

♠ 7

♥ 5 3 2

♦ 7 3

♣ A K J 9 6 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ T 8 4

♥ J 7 4

♦ K Q 8 6

♣ Q 7 3

♠ A K Q 3

♥ K 9 8

♦ A J T

♣ T 8 5

West

North

East

South

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

You know that East has no high ♠ honor or he would have played it to the first trick. So South has the ♠ A Q left, plus all those ♣ tricks. You need to have West switch to a ♥ if possible.

East must be expecting to lead a ♠ back when he wins the ♣Q which you hope he holds. Your ♠J discard may make him rethink. If your ♠s were any good why would you be discarding a winner when all you had to do was toss a small red card?

Hopefully East will come to the conclusion that this is Suit Preference for a ♥ return and will play his ♥J. Hopefully.

[show NW]

[showcards W:S5 S:SK]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♠5, East plays the ♠T and South wins the ♠K. To the second trick South plays the ♣T and you must discard something.

When you have made your choice click NEXT.

[choose-card SJ] [NEXT]

[show NESW]

[clear-commentary]

Play the ♠J.

Board 15

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A K Q 7 3

♥ 4

♦ T 6 5 3

♣ T 7 2

♠ 9 6 2

♥ K T 6 3

♦ Q 9 4

♣ Q J 4



♠ T 4

♥ 9

♦ J 8 7 2

♣ A 9 8 6 5 3

♠ J 8 5

♥ A Q J 8 7 5 2

♦ A K

♣ K

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

2 ♥

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by South
Play the ♣9.

[show NE]

[showcards S:S8,S5 W:SA,SQ,SK]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠A, dummy played the ♠2 and you signal with your ♠T. West next plays the ♠Q and you drop the ♠4, completing your doubleton signal. West then plays the ♠K and it turns out you don't have to ruff after all. So what are you going to play?

When you have made your choice click NEXT.

[choose-card C9] [NEXT]

[show NESW]

[clear-commentary]

This should be a clear enough signal for West to play a ♣ to your ♣A next.

An alternate play, just as good, would be for you to ruff the good ♠Q and play the ♣A yourself.

If you don't get your ♣ trick at trick 4 you will never get it. South will discard his ♣K on North's extra ♦ winner.

Board 16

South Deals

None Vul

♠ T
 ♥ 9 6 4 3
 ♦ 9 7 5
 ♣ K Q T 6 3

♠ Q J 9 8 6 3

♥ Q 7 2

♦ Q 8 4

♣ J



♠ 2
 ♥ A K J
 ♦ J T 6 3 2
 ♣ A 9 7 2

♠ A K 7 5 4

♥ T 8 5

♦ A K

♣ 8 5 4

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠

Pass 4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by South
 instant that you want him to play another ♣.

[show NE]

[showcards W:CK]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.
 Partner led the ♣K, dummy's singleton was played
 and it is your play.

When you have made your choice click NEXT.
 [choose-card C9] [NEXT]

[show NESW]

[clear-commentary]

Play the ♣9.

West will look at your ♣9 and perhaps think for an

But it will be a short instant because a look at dummy makes in absolutely clear to everybody that playing another ♣ could not help your side. Dummy has so many trumps that repeated ♣ leads would do nothing.

OK. If it's not an encouraging Attitude signal, what is it? Suit preference of course. Since it is a high spot card you are asking West to switch to the higher suit (choosing between ♦s and ♥s).

West dutifully plays a ♥ and you take the next three tricks. Had he switched to a ♦ instead, South would have been able to discard one of his ♥ losers on North's ♦Q.

Board 17

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 5
 ♥ 9 7 3
 ♦ A 8 7
 ♣ A K 9 8 6 4

♠ A T 6
 ♥ A K Q 4
 ♦ Q T 3
 ♣ Q J 2



♠ 8 3
 ♥ J T 6 2
 ♦ K J 9 5 4 2
 ♣ 3

♠ K Q J 9 7 4 2
 ♥ 8 5
 ♦ 6
 ♣ T 7 5

West	North	East	South
			3 ♠

Pass 4 ♠
 All Pass

4 ♠ by South
 encourage West to play a second ♦ through dummy's ♦ Q 10.

[show NE]

[showcards W:CA S:C5 W:DA,CA]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.
 Partner led the ♣A. Seeing your ♣3 he next played
 the ♦A. What will you play on this trick?

When you have made your choice click NEXT.
 [choose-card D2] [NEXT]

[show NESW]

[clear-commentary]

Play the ♦ 2.

Normally with this holding you would play the ♦ 9 to

But this time you really want him to take his ♣K. So play the discouraging ♦ 2 and hope he gets the message
 to go back to ♣s. If he does play the ♣K next it will win and he can then give you a ♣ ruff.

Board 18

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 5
 ♥ K Q 8 5 3
 ♦ 9 6 2
 ♣ J 4

♠ 6 4 2

♥ 9 6 4

♦ K Q 8 3

♣ K 7 3



♠ J T 7 3

♥ J 7 2

♦ T 7 5

♣ A 9 5

♠ A K Q

♥ A T

♦ A J 4

♣ Q T 8 6 2

West

North

East

South

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

2NT

[show NE]

[showcards S:HA,DA,DJ,CQ W:H5,D2,D6,C4]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥5, you put on the ♥J, South won with the ♥A. The second trick was ♦A, ♦2, ♦3, ♦5. The third trick was ♦J, ♦6, ♦8, ♦7. South then put the ♣Q on the table.

When you have made your choice click NEXT.

[choose-card CA] [NEXT]

[show NESW]

[clear-commentary]

Play the ♣A.

Does it look to you like South is trying to create an entry to dummy so he can cash the 2 ♦ winners? That's what he wants it to look like, hoping someone holds up their ♣A.

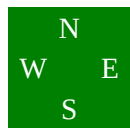
But don't believe Declarer, believe your partner. On the first ♦ West played the ♦2. On the second ♦ he played the ♦6. He has an odd number of ♦s, obviously 3. And South must also have a third one, so he is up to some trickery with that ♣Q.

So grab your ♣A and return partner's ♥ suit.

Board 19
 South Deals
 None Vul

♠ 7 5
 ♥ 9 7 4 2
 ♦ 8 6 2
 ♣ 7 6 5 2

♠ K 9 8 6 4
 ♥ A 6
 ♦ Q J 3
 ♣ A K 9



♠ T 3
 ♥ K Q 8 5
 ♦ 9 7 5 4
 ♣ Q 8 4

♠ A Q J 2
 ♥ J T 3
 ♦ A K T
 ♣ J T 3

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♥	Pass	2♠
Pass	5NT	Pass	6♠
All Pass			

6♠ by South
 Play the ♥K.

[show NESW]

[showcards W:S5]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown. The 2♥ bid was a transfer. The 5NT bid meant to choose either 6♠ or 6NT. South liked the suit. Partner led the ♠5, won by South's ♠Q. South pulls one more trump with his ♠A, then wins three high ♦s. Next comes dummy's ♥A on which he plays the ♥3 and West plays the ♥9. Then he leads dummy's ♥6 which you win with the ♥Q. On this trick South drops the ♥J and West the ♥2. It is your play.

When you have made your choice click NEXT.
 [choose-card HK] [NEXT]

[clear-commentary]

If you believe South is now out of ♥s then you should not play your ♥K because it would give him a ruff-sluff.

But you shouldn't believe South when your partner has sent you a clear signal that he holds an EVEN number of ♥s. In this case an even number must be 4 which means that South has one more ♥. So you play your ♥K. He ruffs in dummy of course, but then has no way to get rid of that ♣ loser when the finesse fails.

If you had not been paying attention to West's signal you might have decided to risk a ♣ lead - with a disastrous result.

Board 20

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A Q T
♥ 9 2
♦ 8 5 2
♣ A K T 6 3

♠ 6 4

♥ A J 8

♦ A Q J 6

♣ 8 7 5 4



♠ 9 8 7 5 2

♥ T 5

♦ 9 7 4 3

♣ Q 2

♠ K J 3

♥ K Q 7 6 4 3

♦ K T

♣ J 9

West	North	East	South
1 ♣	Pass	Pass	1 ♥
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	4 ♥
All Pass			

4 ♥ by South
discouraging signal. Think again.

[show NW]

[showcards W:CA E:C2 S:C9]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♣A, East played the ♣2 and South the ♣9. What should you play to the second trick?

When you have made your choice click NEXT.
[choose-card C6] [NEXT]

[show NESW]

[clear-commentary]

Play the ♣6.

On first thought East's ♣2 seems to be a

After the first trick you know the location of every ♣ except the ♣Q and ♣J. If East started with ♣ J 2 he would have signaled with the ♣J. If East started with ♣ Q J 2 he would have signaled with the ♣Q. Since he did neither he started either with singleton ♣ 2 or with ♣ Q 2. In either case you should play a low ♣ now which he will either win with his ♣Q or he will ruff.

It turns out that he wins with the ♣Q, then leads a ♠ back to your ♠ A Q.